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Cymbals

7.4.2 Cymbals

References:

Hebrew מְצִלְתַּיִם (mtsiltayim) 1CH 13:8, 1CH 15:16, 1CH 15:19, 1CH 15:28, 1CH 16:5, 1CH 16:42, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 25:6, 2CH 5:12, 2CH 5:13, 2CH 29:25, EZR 3:10, NEH 12:27

Hebrew צֶלְצְלִים (tseltselim) 2SA 6:5, PSA 150:5, PSA 150:5

Greek κύμβαλον (kumbalon) 1CO 13:1, JDT 16:1, 1MA 4:54, 1MA 13:51, 1ES 5:57

Description:

Cymbals (© Finoskov, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons)Cymbals were a percussion instrument consisting of two metal discs that were struck together in order to make a shrill, clashing sound. There were two types of cymbals: (1) flat metal plates that were struck together, and (2) metal cones, one of which was brought down on top of the other, on the open end.

Translation:

The equivalent of "cymbal" in many languages is a phrase such as "loud metal."

In PSA 150:5 two kinds of cymbals are mentioned, literally "cymbals of hearing" and "cymbals of shouting." This may mean "small cymbals … large cymbals, or it may be just a poetic variation with the meaning "clanging cymbals … clashing cymbals."

In 1CO 13:1GNT renders the Greek word *kumbalon* as "bell" instead of "cymbal" since it is more widely understood.